

Tobias Treppmann

A design function levelled up because the company bet on a new product

CONTACT

LOCATION

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Leading a design function

Operating model owned outright — capacity, allocation, prioritization, team structure and processes · a levelling framework across design and UX writing · growth plans, performance reviews and a lean 360 run as a workshop · hiring and promoting · a decade mentoring designers

Design systems

DTCG tokens in four tiers · Style Dictionary · Storybook as the source of truth · governance established jointly with engineering · a documented contribution process · adoption driven by making the compliant path the fast one · three companies

Research and quality

Research methodology built rather than inherited · iterative screening to reach unreachable users in regulated industries · a quality bar enforced in CI rather than in review · an exception register that sets the roadmap · outcomes measured on business impact rather than usage

AI in the craft and the product

Agentic engineering introduced from zero and taught outside the company · token vocabularies designed so an assistant's compliant path is its fastest · a support copilot in production with restricted-topic constraints · Claude Code daily for over a year

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, and before it design leadership at ChurchDesk, Ninox and Datameer. At Ninox I owned the design function outright — capacity, allocation, prioritization, team structure and processes — for designers and UX writers. At Datameer the company kept its business and bet on a new product for a shifting market, and design got levelled up because of it. Research won executive backing and design entered roadmap conversations. I have carried the design system at three companies, and the current one enforces itself in the build because nobody is left to review it.

The function was mine

capacity, allocation, prioritization, team structure and processes at Ninox

Levels for two disciplines

a framework covering design and UX writing, used for growth plans

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The design system is mine end to end, and it has to hold without a reviewer. Engineering sits at an outside agency and product managers set direction.
- Design tokens in four DTCG tiers serving iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source, built with Style Dictionary.
- The top two tiers add no new values. They exist so a product team can change a component's spacing without waiting for an agency release.
- Quality is enforced by the build rather than by review. Checks run identically on a laptop and in CI, refusing a hardcoded color or a token reference that does not resolve.
- Drove adoption by making the compliant path the fast one. The token vocabulary is enumerated, so it is quicker to use the system than to work around it.
- That holds for Claude Code writing the first draft as much as for a person.
- Cross-product coherence across four surfaces, with an exception register where every documented escape becomes the system's own backlog.
- Scaled AI into the way the work is done, from zero. Agentic engineering was not a practice here before; it is now the daily method.
- The point of view is a constraint in the token schema, not an opinion — an assistant can only express on-system values.
- Prototype in production code against real APIs, and the engineering agency ships from that code.
- Product manager and product owner for the redesign alongside design, so I own what gets built and not only how it looks.
- Shipped an AI support copilot into production where a mistake reaches a viewer, with a restricted-topic list and a scope rule that refuses to draft outside its remit.
- Four surfaces, one Style Dictionary source.
- Nobody reviews it. Six CI checks do.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Led all product design across the company, and held product management for the main platform alongside it.
- Reframed a customer request into a platform capability. It arrived as a funeral-booking feature and shipped as booking built into the platform.
- One build then carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings, to every customer. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.
- Measured on the business outcome rather than on usage — coordination time and acceptance, not screens viewed.
- An accessibility law landed on customers who host their sites with us. We audited ours and theirs against the European Accessibility Act and shipped the capability that met it automatically.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design function's operating model: capacity, allocation, prioritization of work, team structure and processes.
- A dedicated design team, with designers assigned to specific product teams' work — neither a central agency nor fully embedded.
- Developed a levelling framework covering design and UX writing — two disciplines, which is the part most teams with writers never solve.
- It set clear expectations per level, and drove growth plans for a junior designer and a junior writer.

- Ran performance reviews, and designed a lean 360 as a workshop rather than a survey, so the feedback happened in a room between the people it was about.
- Hired two, promoted two, and hired the consultant who became Head of Product permanently.
- Owned the design system and built its governance — a cross-functional working group with a design lead and an engineering lead, and a documented contribution process.
- Ran design and product at the same time for four months, nine people across four disciplines, on the senior leadership team.
- Redesigned how the team ran meetings for an engineer who was being sidelined in them. Pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking.
- That engineer became one of the strongest contributors. Changing the conditions, not managing the person.
- Nine people, four disciplines, four months.
- Levels for UX writers too, not only designers.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- The company kept its business and bet on a new product for a shifting market. Design was levelled up because of that bet.
- Research won executive backing and design entered roadmap conversations — the function moved from executing to deciding.
- Built a research method that did not exist here, screening iteratively to reach analysts inside banks and insurers who would let no vendor watch them work.
- Standard panels could not reach them, so an inherited research practice would not have solved it.
- Defined how components behaved across the shared library: what each one guaranteed, and where it could be used.
- Briefed freelance designers alongside the employed team.
- Led the design team across Germany and New York. Five years of enterprise interfaces under regulation.
- usertesting.com panels could not reach them.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin · Holacracy Secretary and Facilitator

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig · inside a product triad, 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA